



5/42

His match-winning haul against New Zealand

Varun Chakaravarthi

India's late decision to include Varun Chakaravarthi in the squad paid off as he finished second on the wicket-takers list, claiming nine wickets in three matches at an average of just over 15.

Despite having just one ODI appearance before the tournament, he thrived under pressure, completing India's spin quartet and reinforcing its horses-for-courses approach on Dubai's slow pitches.

His 5/42 against New Zealand in the group stage was only the second five-wicket haul by a spinner at the Dubai International Cricket Stadium, after Shahid Afridi's 6/38 in 2009.

Known for his variations in the IPL, Chakaravarthi relied mostly on his leg-spin (111 balls) and googly (60), with his quicker ball, carrom ball, and slider used just nine times. Yet, he remained unpredictable, taking five wickets with the googly (economy 3.70), one with the slider, and three with his stock delivery.



2.81

Economy rate of his googly, which took four wickets

Kuldeep Yadav

Like Chakaravarthi, Kuldeep Yadav proved a tough challenge for batters with his variations.

His googly, bowled 66 times in five matches, yielded four wickets while conceding just 31 runs at an economy rate of 2.81. It played a crucial role in the final, deceiving Rachin Ravindra and halting his aggressive start on 37.

Like the rest of India's spin quartet, Kuldeep choked the scoring in the middle overs, maintaining an economy of 4.56. Among bowlers who delivered 150+ balls between overs 11 and 40, his dot-ball rate (52.7%) was bettered only by Mitchell Santner and Michael Bracewell. He also induced the highest percentage of false shots (16.3%) in this phase, with the next-best Indian spinner, Ravindra Jadeja, managing 10.7%.